

UNH-PO-HR08 Job Evaluation Policy

Policy/Guideline Title:	Job Evaluation Policy		
Executive Summary:	University Hospitals of Northamptonshire NHS Group is committed to recognising individual contributions towards success in the delivery of healthcare and ensuring that the bands of all posts reflect the requirements of the post in line with the Agenda for Change Job Evaluation Scheme. This policy recognises the need for fairness, equality and openness in the process of determining the correct reward for the work undertaken. To ensure pay bands comply with the Equality Act 2010 principles of equal pay for work of equal value, we will maintain a consistent partnership approach to the evaluation of posts which is underpinned by the guidance and procedures contained within the NHS Job Evaluation Handbook.		
Supersedes:	KGH Job Evaluation Policy (B2.1) and NGH Job Banding Policy (PO-NGH-878)		
Description of Amendment(s):	Full review and harmonisation of the policies		
This policy will impact on:			
Policy Area:	People Division	Approval Date:	30 November 2022 (Updated September 2023)
Version Number:	1.1	Review Date:	November 2025
Issued By:	Andrew Stewart, Acting Deputy Chief People Officer	Expiry Date:	28 February 2026
Author:	Sarah Kinsella, HR Business Partner	Impact Assessment Date:	11 October 2022
APPROVAL RECORD			
	Committees / Group	Date	
Consultation:	Group Policy Review Forum	08 November 2022	
Endorsed by Head of Function:	Paula Kirkpatrick, Chief People Officer	08 November 2022	
Ratified by:	UHN Policy Ratification Group	30 November 2022	
Received for Information:			

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1. Introduction

As per the National NHS Job Evaluation Scheme for Agenda for Change (AfC) roles, all posts must be evaluated, and consistency checked to determine the band of the post. This applies to:

- All new posts, where a banding has not previously been applied
- A vacant post that has been previously evaluated and significant changes are required prior to recruitment
- Posts that have been previously evaluated and subsequently reviewed as part of an organisational change programme if there are significant changes
- Posts where there have been significant changes since its original evaluation.

This policy does not need to be applied where there are straight replacements for existing posts that have already been aligned to a pay band previously through the Job Evaluation Scheme, a similar position has already been evaluated, or where there have been minor wording updates.

Further supporting information on Job Evaluation can be found via

- [KNET](#)
- [The Street](#)

2. Purpose

This policy outlines the process to request a job banding evaluation, for posts covered by Agenda for Change (AfC) Terms and Conditions.

The purpose of this policy is to ensure job evaluation is carried out in a fair, objective and consistent manner in accordance with the NHS Job Evaluation Scheme, which is based on a number of clear principles:

- Partnership working between the Trust and Staff Side underpins this process
- Job Matching or Evaluation is related to the post and not the individual person who happens to be in the post at any given time
- Matching or Evaluation of a post will be carried out based on the content of the job description, person specification and organisational structure for the role and must be completed prior to a recruitment/organisational change taking place.

3. Scope

This policy applies to all Trust posts that are covered by AfC Terms and Conditions of Service.

4. Job Evaluation Process

The Job Evaluation Scheme is divided into four main processes:

- Job matching
- Local job evaluation
- Consistency checking
- Appeal process

4.1 How to Submit a Post for Job Evaluation

If you feel that there have been significant changes to your position since it was evaluated, you can discuss this with your manager and request that the position is submitted for job evaluation. This has to be discussed and agreed with your manager.

Your manager must complete the Job Evaluation Request Form (ensuring that the form is completed in full and all relevant signatures are obtained) and submit the completed and signed form together with the job description/person specification (in the correct template) and organisational chart to:

KGH – kgh-tr.Job.Evaluation@nhs.net

NGH – sarah.kinsella5@nhs.net

The Job Evaluation Request Form is available here on [KNET](#) or [The Street](#).

Current job description/person specification templates are available here on [KNET](#) or [The Street](#).

Managers are responsible for ensuring that funding is available for posts that are being submitted and must obtain funding approval as indicated on the Job Evaluation Request Form.

For roles where there is a current postholder and the reason for submissions is due to changes to the role since original banding of the job description, the following will apply and need to be considered:

- The manager should amend the job description using track changes. If the changes are not tracked, the job description will be returned to the manager
- Posts will not normally be considered within 12 months of a previous review unless there is clear evidence to demonstrate significant changes to the role and responsibilities
- Consideration must be given as to whether a change to one job description may impact on other post holders within the Team/Trust and advice regarding this can be sought from the People Team
- Consideration should be given as to whether additional responsibility being attached to one post will create a reduction of duties/skills/qualifications of other posts and potential cause a decrease to these. It may be that tasks that warrant a higher banding may be removed and reallocated within the structure.

In cases where the changes to the job description or person specification are very minor and there is no anticipated change to the factor scores, or the band originally awarded there may not be a need to take the role to a panel.

Jobs will be booked onto scheduled Job Evaluation Panels in the date order they are received. However, any jobs submitted without the correct authorisation or on incorrect templates will be returned, which may cause a significant delay in the process.

We aim to complete the Job Evaluation process within 6 weeks of the date of submission of all completed and correct paperwork. If for any reason this is not possible, we will ensure that this is communicated to submitting managers so they are aware of any delays.

4.2 Job Evaluation Panels

Panels will be undertaken in line with the NHS Job Evaluation Scheme Handbook. A team of trained panel members will meet on a regular basis to undertake panels. The panel will be carried out in partnership and must consist of at least two trained members from both Management and Staff Side.

The panel may contact the manager of the post for clarification of the job description and person specification during the process.

The primary method to be used will be Job Matching against a nationally agreed profile, which will evaluate the role against 16 Factors. National Profiles are available for posts which are standard within the NHS, and which have many common features with other similar roles.

If it is not possible to match the role against a National Profile because the role is unique and/or significantly different to other similar roles elsewhere in the NHS, it will need to be locally evaluated. In these circumstances a Job Analysis Questionnaire (JAQ) which will be agreed by the Manager and post holder (where appropriate), will need to be completed and trained evaluators will be able to provide support and guidance on how to complete the questionnaire. Once completed the JAQ will be submitted to a further panel for evaluation.

4.3 Consistency Checking

All posts that have been to a job evaluation panel are required to be consistency checked by a second panel which must consist of a minimum of two members from both Management and Staff Side who have been trained in consistency checking.

If any inconsistencies are found these will be referred back to the original panel for further consideration.

4.4 Panel Outcomes

On completion of the job evaluation process, decisions will be emailed to the manager. If the post is vacant, it can be advertised in line with recruitment processes. If the post is not vacant and the banding outcome has changed as result of the evaluation, that change should be backdated to when the colleague and their

manager agreed the job had changed. Disputes about backdating should be resolved through our local grievance procedure.

A change form that has been authorised through the employing Trust's process will need to be submitted for each colleague affected.
The changes will need to be confirmed to the colleague/s in writing by their manager and a copy of the letter placed on their personal file.

The People Team will also record and keep records of the outcomes and reports on their job evaluation systems.

4.5 Appeals

If a manager or the post holder believes that the outcome of the job matching is incorrect, then a request for it to be reviewed can be made, by the submission of an appeal within one week of the date the outcome was sent to the manager.

In order for a review to be undertaken the manager or post holder must provide details of where they disagree with the match/evaluation and provide evidence to support this. A review should only be requested if the manager/post holder can demonstrate that incorrect or insufficient information concerning the job was presented to the original panel, or they believe the process has not been applied correctly.

If any amendments are made to the job description or person specification these will need to be tracked. If the changes are not tracked, the job description will be returned to the manager. The review will be undertaken by another panel who will have the majority of its members different to the original panel and must consist of at least two trained members from both Management and Staff Side.

4.6 Group Roles

In the case of Group roles that need taking through the job evaluation process, the above principles will apply and panels will be made up of members from both Northampton General Hospital NHS Trust and Kettering General Hospital NHS Foundation Trust.

5. Definitions

Job Evaluation	The process of determining the value of a post using the NHS Job Evaluation Scheme.
Job Matching	The job details are matched to a national profile in order to give a pay banding.
National Profiles	Profiles are the outcome of evaluation of jobs, and may be specific to a job group, or generic to apply to a range of posts.
Job Analysis	The process of systematically identifying the critical elements of a job (duties and responsibilities) and the necessary knowledge, skills, abilities and other personal

characteristics (competencies) required by way of a Job Analysis Questionnaire (JAQ) and then using that JAQ to determine the value of a job using the NHS Job Evaluation Scheme.

Consistency Checking

The process of ensuring that all job matching and evaluations are accurate and consistent with the posts matched or evaluated across the Trust and with national profiles in order to avoid grading anomalies.

Significant Change

These may be changes such as qualifications required or additional duties, responsibilities and/or accountability.

Minor Change

These may be specific/different tasks or areas of responsibility at the same level.

6. Training

All panel members must be appropriately trained in line with the requirements of the NHS Job Evaluation Scheme.

7. Monitoring Compliance with the Document

Requirement of the policy and compliance to be monitored	Frequency of audit	Responsibility for audit	Results of monitoring reported at:
Number of jobs matched/banded in year	Annual	<i>Head of People Partnering</i>	Union Group Policy Review Forum (GPRF)
Audit 10% roles banded within the year to ensure banded and consistency checked	Annual	<i>Head of People Partnering</i>	Union Group Policy Review Forum (GPRF)
Number of appeal/reviews undertaken	Annual	<i>Head of People Partnering</i>	Union Group Policy Review Forum (GPRF)

8. References

The NHS Constitution for England (2021)

NHS Job Evaluation Handbook (2018)

NHS Terms and Conditions of Service Handbook (2022)

Kettering General Hospital NHS Foundation Trust (2021) Job Evaluation Policy

Northampton General Hospital NHS Trust (2021) Job Banding Policy

Yeovil District Hospital NHS Foundation Trust (2021) Human Resources Policy Manual

APPENDIX A – RESPONSIBILITIES

1. **The Director of People** is responsible for the implementation and monitoring of this policy and will ensure that it is properly introduced and that employees receive appropriate information, guidance and training.
2. **Managers** are responsible for ensuring that:
 - This policy is implemented and operates effectively in their sphere of control;
 - Employees' attention is drawn to the requirements and purpose of this policy and their individual responsibilities in this respect;
 - All matters are dealt with in a fair, consistent and sensitive manner, and are appropriately documented;
 - Any concerns raised under the scope of this policy are treated in a timely manner
 - and are treated seriously and sensitively and in confidence;
 - Consistent support is provided by managers to employees at all stages throughout the job evaluation process and any potential appeal/ review.
 - Job descriptions are reviewed as part of employees' Performance Development Review;
 - All documentations is provided when required; and they are available to participate in all stages of the job evaluation process, as required.
 - Trained job evaluators are released to participate in the job evaluation process
3. The **People Team**, in partnership with the staff side job evaluation lead, are responsible for ensuring that:
 - Consistent advice and support is provided to managers/employees at all stages throughout the job evaluation process and any potential appeal/ review;
 - Training is provided on the application of this policy;
 - Documentation is completed appropriately prior to being submitted;
 - A rolling programme of panels is maintained to enable timely evaluations and consistency checking to be undertaken;
 - Robust and comprehensive records are maintained;
 - The job evaluation process is adhered to
 - This policy is applied fairly and consistently and is reviewed in accordance with legislative changes and best practice.
4. **Trained Job Evaluators/Consistency Checkers** are responsible for:
 - Undertaking job evaluation/consistency checking in line with NHS Job Evaluation Scheme
 - Maintaining confidentiality with regard to all aspects of work undertaken as panel members
 - Committing to participate in panels on a regular basis

- Attending evaluation/consistency checking panels to which they have given a commitment.

5. Every **employee has a responsibility to:**

- Adhere to the requirements and purpose of this policy;
- Draw to the attention of managers where they are significantly working outside the remit of their job description;
- Co-operate with the procedures outlined

APPENDIX B – EIA FORM

Equality Impact Assessment (EIA) – Initial Assessment			
1. Division	People Services	2. Department	People Services
3. Person(s) completing this form	Michelle O’Sullivan, Senior HR Advisor	4. Contact Information	Michelle.osullivan5@nhs.net
5. Others involved		6. Start date of this assessment	11 October 2022
7. What is being assessed (please tick)	New Policy ☒ Existing Policy ☐ New Service / Function ☐ Review Service / Function ☐	8. Implementation/ effective date	End of October 2022
9. Name of Policy	Job Evaluation Policy		
10. What are the aims / objectives of policy this service?	This Policy details the Job Evaluation process for the University Hospitals of Northamptonshire (UHoN) Group. The purpose of this document is to establish a framework of principles and procedures for evaluating jobs in accordance with the Agenda for Change Job Evaluation Scheme.		
11. Who will be impacted by policy / service (please tick)	Patients ☐ Carers ☐ Public ☐ Staff ☐ Other ☐	11a. If staff are impacted, how many individuals / Which Groups of Staff are likely to be affected?	All
12. Who has been involved in the policy / service development (please tick)	Patients ☐ Carers ☐ Public ☐ Staff ☒ Other ☒	12a. If yes, who have you involved and how have they been involved	Unions, Managers, HR Team, Solicitors
13. What further consultation method(s), if any, are you proposing?	Formal consultation through Trust established Trade Union negotiation forum	14. How are any changes / amendments to the policy / service to be communicated?	Formal consultation period

Equality Impact Assessment – Initial Assessment Outcome

15. As part of the completing the above have you or a member of the group conducting EIA identified any issues relating to the specific service/policy and gender, race, age, religion, physical disability, hearing impairment / sensory impairment / mental illness / learning disabilities / sexual orientation / gender reassignment / marriage & civil partnership / pregnancy & maternity and carer status?	No	☐	EIA Complete (please send completed EIA to kgh-tr.diversity@nhs.net)
	Yes	☒	Requires EIA Full Assessment to be completed.

Equality Impact Assessment – Full Assessment

Review of any previous EIA actions

What actions did you plan last time? (List them from the previous EIA)	What improved as a result? What outcomes have these actions achieved?	What <u>further</u> actions do you need to take? (add these to the Action plan below)
Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable

Review of information, equality analysis and potential actions

Protected characteristics groups from the Equality Act 2010	What do you know? Summary of data about your service-users and/or staff	What do people tell you? Summary of service-user and/or staff feedback	What does this mean? Positive / Neutral / Negative Impact identified from data and feedback (actual and potential)	What can you do? All potential actions to: • advance equality of opportunity, • eliminate discrimination, and • foster good relations
Age	Previously job descriptions required set periods of time i.e., 5 years' experience	N/A	N/A	No time frames to be referenced in job descriptions or person specifications
Disability	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Gender reassignment	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Pregnancy and maternity	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Race/ethnicity Including migrants, refugees and asylum seekers	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Religion or belief	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A

Protected characteristics groups from the Equality Act 2010	What do you know? Summary of data about your service-users and/or staff	What do people tell you? Summary of service-user and/or staff feedback	What does this mean? Positive / Neutral / Negative Impact identified from data and feedback (actual and potential)	What can you do? All potential actions to: • advance equality of opportunity, • eliminate discrimination, and • foster good relations
Sex/Gender	Recommended roles are not genderised. Where gendered term has been used, needs to be reviewed to non-gender term	N/A	N/A	Nursing roles to be reviewed to remove genderised roles within employment
Sexual orientation	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Marriage and civil partnership	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Community Cohesion	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Other relevant groups	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Cumulative impact	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A

Equality Impact Assessment – Full Assessment Outcome

Assessment of overall impacts and any further recommendations	TBC
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Equality Impact Assessment – Detailed list of data/community feedback that informed your EIA

Title (of data, research or engagement)	Date	Gaps in data	Actions to fill these gaps: who else do you need to engage with? (add these to the Action Plan below, with a timeframe)
WRES Data at KGH	2021/2022	N/A	N/A
WDES Data at KGH	2021/2022	N/A	N/A
Gender Pay Gap report for KGH	2022	N/A	N/A
WRES Data at NGH	2021/22	N/A	N/A

WDES Data at NGH	2021/22	N/A	N/A
Gender Pay Gap report for NGH	2022	N/A	N/A

Equality Impact Assessment – Prioritised Action Plan¹

Impact identified and group(s) affected	Action planned	Expected outcome	Measure of success	Timeframe

¹ These actions must now be transferred to service or business plans and monitored to ensure they achieve the outcomes identified.

Equality Impact Assessment – Initial Assessment Outcome

As part of the completing the above have you or a addressed all issues identified as part of EIA initial assessment	No	☐	Please speak to Diversity and Inclusion Manager
	Yes	☒	EIA Complete (please send completed EIA to kgh-tr.diversity@nhs.net)